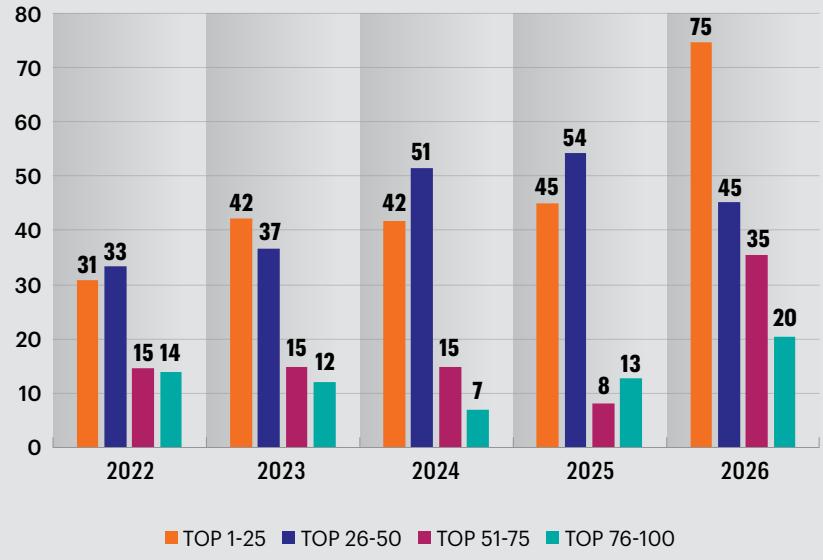


"Roughly 10-15% students today are reaching to do something on their own. The societal acceptance of entrepreneurial enterprise orientation is much better than ever before"

DEBASHIS CHATTERJEE
DIRECTOR, IIM KOZHIKODE

AVERAGE SUCCESSFUL START-UPs

The *BT*-MDRA survey found that the number of successful start-ups at top 25 B-schools increased 60% from the previous year



SOURCE SOURCE BT-MDRA BEST B-SCHOOLS SURVEY 2026-27

A LAUNCH PAD

India's B-schools are responding to this changing calculus. Incubators, founder programmes, alumni networks, investor access and start-up-focused courses are becoming part of the campus infrastructure. The objective is not simply to persuade students to become entrepreneurs, but to make entrepreneurship a credible career pathway alongside the traditional corporate route.

From IIM Bangalore's NSRCEL and ISB Hyderabad's DLabs to IIM Ahmedabad's CIIE.CO, India's top B-schools are getting increasingly serious about building the infrastructure, networks, and support systems needed to turn entrepreneurial ambition into businesses.

Speaking with *Business Today*, Debashis Chatterjee, Director, IIM Kozhikode, describes what he is seeing as a "very significant momentum shift towards entrepreneurship". Among undergraduate students, roughly 10-15% are interested in doing something on their own rather than taking a conventional job.

XLRI's interpretation is more measured. (Fr.) Sebastian George, SJ, Director, XLRI—Xavier School of Management, Jamshedpur, cautions against reading the trend as students abandoning corporate careers. Instead, entrepreneurship is being treated as another form of leadership.

"Entrepreneurship in our view is most meaningful when innovation is accompanied by a clear understanding of its impact on employees, communities, markets and the wider society," he says.

That distinction is important. The story unfolding across India's B-schools is not necessarily about the death of the MBA-to-corporate-job pipeline. It is about that pipeline becoming less linear.

FOUNDER TRAINING GROUND

Deloitte's Campus Workforce Trends 2026 study fixes another piece of the puzzle. It does not establish that MBA students are taking corporate jobs to prepare for entrepreneurship. It shows that the roles attracting MBA talent are increasingly building capabilities that are also useful for creating and scaling businesses.

Management consulting and product management for AI-enabled products are among the preferred roles for MBA students, while capabilities such as agile project management, change management, data analytics and